Lesson Plan: Listening for Ideas and Sound Patterns

Intermediate | Adult ESL learners | Community college | 50 minutes | Topic: What are genetically modified foods?

Goal

Learners build listening comprehension and vocabulary through interactive tasks with authentic content on genetically modified (GM) foods.

Objectives

- Identify and use key vocabulary related to GM foods.
- Understand the main ideas and details of a video.
- Recognize linking and stress patterns in natural speech.
- Discuss opinions collaboratively using target vocabulary.

Materials

- A short video on GM foods [add link; the video is not included here]
- Vocabulary cards and definitions, picture cards, sticky notes
- Worksheet and basket of detail questions
- Opinion Corners cards (separate PDF)

Procedure

Stage	Time	What happens
Pre-listening	10 min	**Word Match Game (pairs):** match 8 vocabulary words (gene, organism, modify, crop, trait, DNA, resistant, natural) with lettered definitions displayed on the board. Ask which words learners expect to hear. **Prediction brainstorm:** each learner writes one prediction on a sticky note and posts it; the teacher reads a few aloud. *Assessment:* the teacher observes pairs matching terms and definitions.
While listening	25 min	**First listening (gist):** learners watch without notes, write one sentence about what the video is mainly about, share with a partner, and the teacher confirms. **Second listening (details):** in groups of 3, a representative picks question cards from a basket and the group answers on the worksheet, then shares with the class. **Third listening (sound patterns):** groups jot down examples of linking and stressed words (for example *kind of, out of, scientists want to create*) and repeat after the video to practice rhythm.
Post-listening	15 min	**Opinion Corners:** three cards are posted around the room (*GM foods are good / GM foods are bad / I'm not sure*). Learners move to a corner and discuss *Why do you think that? What did you learn from the video?* using at least three target words. Each group shares one idea. **Exit ticket:** on a sticky note, write one new word and one thing learned about GM foods.

Assessment

- Formative checks at every stage: matching, one-sentence summaries, group answers, linking and stress examples, and the exit ticket.

Appendix: Materials

Word match (pre-listening)

Definition	Letter
A small part of DNA that decides how a living thing looks	A
Any living thing: plant, animal or microbe	B
To change something by making it better or different	C
A plant grown by farmers for food or other use	D
A special quality or feature that something has	E
The material in cells that carries genetic information	F
Able to fight off disease, insects or damage	G
Not made or changed by humans	H

Answer key: gene A, organism B, modify C, crop D, trait E, DNA F, resistant G, natural H.

Listening worksheet

Listening	Question	Your answer
First listening	Write one sentence about what the video is mainly about.	
Second listening	What is a genetically modified food? Why do scientists modify foods? What are some examples of GMOs? What are some concerns about GMOs?	
Third listening	Write down 4 examples of linking words and stressed words you heard in the video.	